

## Acting FEMA chief resigns

Richardson had been hard to reach during Texas flooding in July

BY BRIANNA SACKS

David Richardson on Monday resigned as acting head of the Federal Emergency Management Agency, ending a brief tenure leading an agency that the Trump administration has publicly expressed a desire to dismantle.

Richardson, who spent about six months as the acting head of the nation's disaster response agency, has kept a low profile and is known for often being inaccessible, including during the early hours of the flood disaster in Texas over the Fourth of July weekend.

In recent months, five current agency employees said Richardson spent little time in daily operations meetings and shrank away from the role — one that typically demands the administrator be easily reachable. The staffers, like others interviewed for this story and previous coverage, spoke on the condition of anonymity out of fear of retaliation.

After The Washington Post and other outlets reported Richardson's resignation Monday, Department of Homeland Security assistant secretary for public affairs Tricia McLaughlin said in a statement that FEMA's current chief of staff, Karen Evans, will "step into this important role" at the beginning of December. DHS oversees the emergency management agency.

Richardson handed in his resignation letter Monday morning, according to a person familiar with the situation, and plans to go

SEE FEMA ON A4

## U.S. Anglican archbishop suspended amid probe

BY IAN SHAPIRA

The archbishop of the Anglican Church in North America — who is facing allegations of sexual misconduct against two women — was suspended Sunday from his duties leading the 16-year-old denomination.

Stephen Wood, 62, a married father who has been an archbishop since June 2024, has been temporarily removed from his job and all clerical duties by the denomination's dean, Bishop Julian Dobbs. In his order announcing the suspension, Dobbs said he issued it with the consent of five of the church's most senior bishops. The suspension, Dobbs wrote, will last "no longer than 60 days" unless it is extended. The decision to "inhibit" Wood, as the church calls the disciplinary process, comes as he faces a possible ecclesiastical trial that could lead to his defrocking.

"This action does not determine guilt or innocence, nor does it pre-judge any allegation or future proceeding," Dobbs wrote in the order.

Despite his suspension, Wood technically remains the denomi-

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## Postwar life takes shape in Gaza



HAITHAM IMAD/EPA/SHUTTERSTOCK

Palestinians at Nasser Hospital in Khan Younis, Gaza, await relatives who had been receiving treatment in Israel before Oct. 7, 2023. Israel transported a number of such patients back to the enclave on Monday, the same day that the U.N. Security Council approved President Donald Trump's 20-point peace plan for Gaza. **Story, A15**

## Abortion fight could doom ACA plans in Congress

BY RILEY BEGGIN AND THEODORIC MEYER

Democrats emerged from the longest government shutdown in U.S. history with a hard-won promise from Republicans: The Senate will vote next month on legislation to extend Affordable Care Act subsidies that Democrats desperately want to preserve before they expire at the end of the year.

But Democrats will need Republican votes to pass a bill — and a deep divide between the two parties over abortion is already threatening to scuttle any deal.

Republicans, under pressure

### Lawmakers are divided on potential changes to federal subsidies

from antiabortion advocates, have insisted that any extension should include additional restrictions on abortion coverage for plans that get government subsidies. Democrats will refuse that request.

"That's the message that we've shared with a lot of our Democrat colleagues: You can't do it under your existing framework, and you're never going to get any

Republican votes because we believe strongly taxpayer dollars should not go to fund abortions," said Sen. Mike Rounds (R-South Dakota). "It's pretty clear Republicans are solid on that particular issue."

Democrats argue that the subsidies already contain abortion restrictions and that Republicans are picking a fight that will doom the nascent negotiations.

"To think that they would use this as the demand, which they know is not ever going to get Democratic support — what it tells me is that they're not serious about extending these tax credits, and they're not actually trying to find a path forward,"

said Sen. Tina Smith (D-Minnesota).

For months, Democrats have been pushing Republicans to extend premium subsidies that Congress put in place under President Joe Biden in 2021 to support most of the 24 million Americans enrolled in ACA insurance plans. Without an agreement, more than 20 million people who benefit from the subsidies will face higher health insurance premiums, and millions are expected to become uninsured.

Democrats said they wouldn't vote to fund the government unless the subsidies were extended. But Republicans refused to

SEE ABORTION ON A8

## 'Uncle Dennis' takes center stage in an NBA scandal

Leonard's adviser helped the Clippers star build his business — and courted controversy

BY ALBERT SAMAHA AND SAM FORTIER

LOS ANGELES — The meeting was set for a July afternoon in 2019, and the goal was clear: Close the deal with Kawhi Leonard, the reigning Finals MVP and top prize of the NBA summer.

With stakes that high, the Los Angeles Clippers enlisted big names: Doc Rivers, their coach who hosted the meeting at his house in Malibu; Jerry West, the Hall of Famer and team consultant; Lawrence Frank, the team's president of basketball operations; and Steve Ballmer, the richest owner in basketball.

Leonard brought his agent, his mom, Kim, and his uncle, Dennis Robertson. Only Leonard and his agent were officially authorized to negotiate. But as the meeting went on, it was clear to West whom the Clippers needed to win over.

"Dennis seemed to be the commander of the roost," West said later, in a previously unreported deposition for a lawsuit related to the team's pursuit of Leonard.

Robertson, a retired banking executive and Leonard's

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FRANK GUNN/ASSOCIATED PRESS

Raptors forward Kawhi Leonard, center, posed with his uncle Dennis Robertson and his mother, Kim, after being named the MVP of the 2019 NBA Finals. Leonard signed with the Clippers that year.

## Judge assails Comey case

'PROFOUND' ERRORS BY PROSECUTOR

Government misconduct may have tainted process

BY JEREMY ROEBUCK AND PERRY STEIN

A federal judge on Monday offered a blistering assessment of the Justice Department's case against former FBI director James B. Comey, detailing what he described as a "disturbing pattern of profound investigative missteps" and possible misconduct that could imperil the prosecution.

U.S. Magistrate Judge William Fitzpatrick criticized authorities for their "cavalier" attitude toward the rights of Comey and others. Lindsey Halligan, the Trump-appointed U.S. attorney overseeing the case, also appeared to have made "fundamental misstatements of the law" to the grand jury that indicted Comey on charges of lying to Congress, he wrote.

Those irregularities "potentially undermine the integrity of the grand jury proceeding," Fitzpatrick said. He ordered the Justice Department to hand over full transcripts of those proceedings to the defense.

Late Monday, the federal district judge overseeing the Comey case temporarily paused Fitzpatrick's order at the Justice Department's request. U.S. District Judge Michael Nachmanoff said he would review Fitzpatrick's decision and decide in the coming days whether to uphold it.

In Fitzpatrick's 24-page opinion

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## D.C. halfway house lacks details for completion

BY LIAM BOWMAN

When D.C.'s only halfway house for men closed in 2020 after years of complaints over its safety and lack of basic services, advocates and former inmates saw it as a win for those on the verge of release from prison. Back then, federal prison officials said its replacement would be up and running within a matter of months.

More than five years later, that long-promised D.C. halfway house remains a construction site, little more than a concrete foundation and a trail of blown deadlines.

Many D.C. men returning from prison are instead sent to halfway houses in Baltimore and Delaware, isolated from their communities and far from the reentry programs meant to help them prepare to go home.

CORE DC, the company that won the \$64 million contract to build and operate the halfway house, blames the delays on high construction costs and groundwater at the site, as well as political and bureaucratic holdups.

The company has been paid

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## Inside OPINION

A first look at Venezuela's "Freedom Manifesto" from Nobel Peace Prize winner María Corina Machado.

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